ADAM OKULICZ-KOZARYN [updated: 2026:10]

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https://theaok.github.io
http://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=pz9RYloAAAAJ

EMPLOYMENT

Associate Professor of Public Policy, Rutgers University, the State University of New Jersey, Camden, 2018-present

Assistant Professor of Public Policy, Rutgers University, the State University of New Jersey, Camden, 2012-18

Research Scientist at Texas Schools Project (2010-11) and Clinical Assistant Professor, UT-Dallas, 2010-12

EDUCATION

Post-doctoral Fellow, Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University, 2008-10

PhD Public Policy and Political Economy, The University of Texas at Dallas, 2008

MS Corporate and Economic Policy, Poznan University of Economics (Poland), 2003

BS Banking and Finance, Poznan School of Banking (Poland), 2001

MAJOR PUBLICATIONS (all on Google Scholar; publications with students listed under service; AOK=Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn; click text for PDF)

2026 Golden L, Valente RR, AOK, Mikhaeil E, Do Unpredictable and Unstable Work Hours Reduce Subjective Wellbeing? Social Indicators Research

Urbanization and Happiness. A Research Agenda for Happiness. Why we want to know, what we know, and what we want to know additionally. Editors: Jan Ott and Ruut Veenhoven. Edward Elgar Publishing

2025 AOK, Martinez L Colombia: Unlivable but Happy. Fool's Paradise? (No, a Real Paradise, Better than the US) Applied Research in Quality of Life

2024 D'Italia M, AOK, Constructing General Human Agency Indicators (GHAIs) and a General Personal Agency Scale (GPAS) Social Indicators Research

Urban Regrets (Unhappy Metros: Satisfaction With Life Scale (SWLS)) Heliyon

2023 Magdy Zaki E, AOK, Valente RR, Subjective Well-being and Urbanization in Egypt Cities

AOK, Everett B, Magdy Zaki E, Happiness is In The Air if It Grows (Growing Places are Happier than Shrinking ones) Urban Affairs Review

2022 Unhappy Metros: Panel Evidence Applied Research in Quality of Life

AOK, Valente R, Misanthropolis: Do Cities Promote Misanthropy? Cities

2021 AOK, Valente R, Urban unhappiness is common Cities

AOK, Morawski L, A similar effect of volunteering and pensions on subjective wellbeing of elderly Economics and Sociology

2020 Valente R, AOK, Religiosity and Trust: Evidence from the United States Review of Religious Research

AOK, Valente R, The Perennial Dissatisfaction of Urban Upbringing Cities

AOK, Morawski L, Effect of volunteering and pensions on subjective wellbeing of elderly–are there cross-country differences? Applied Research in Quality of Life

2019 Are we happier among our own race? Economics and Sociology

AOK, Altman M, The Energy Paradox: Energy Use And Happiness Applied Research in Quality of Life

2018 AOK, Valente R, No Urban Malaise for Millennials Regional Studies

2017 AOK, Valente R, Livability and Subjective Wellbeing Across European Cities Applied Research in Quality of Life

Strzelecka M, AOK, Is tourism conducive to residents' social trust? Evidence from large-scale surveys. Tourism Review

AOK, Valente R, Life Satisfaction of Career Women and Housewives Applied Research in Quality of Life

AOK, Valente R, City Life: Glorification, Desire, and the Unconscious Size Fetish, ed. by I Kapoor, in Psychoanalysis and the Global, University of Nebraska Press

AOK, Golden L, Happiness is flextime Applied Research in Quality of Life

2016 AOK, Strzelecka M, Happy Tourists, Unhappy Locals Social Indicators Research

Happiness Research for Public Policy and Administration Transforming Government: People, Process and Policy

Unhappy Metropolis (When American City Is Too Big) Cities

AOK, Mazelis J M, More Unequal in Income, More Unequal in WellBeing Social Indicators Research

AOK, Mazelis J M, Urbanism and Happiness: A Test of Wirth's Theory of Urban Life Urban Studies

2015 Freedom and Life Satisfaction in Transition Society and Economy

AOK, Nash T, Tursi N O, Luxury Car Owners Are Not Happier Than Frugal Car Owners International Review of Economics

The More Religiosity, the Less Creativity Across US Counties Business Creativity & the Creative Economy

Income Inequality and Wellbeing Applied Research in Quality of Life

!!: `this book is excluded from the promotion packet (this is a popular science book)` Happiness and Place: Cities v Nature. Why Life is Better Outside of the City? Palgrave Macmillan

2014 AOK, Holmes IV O, Avery D R, The Subjective Well-Being Political Paradox: Happy Welfare States and Unhappy Liberals Journal of Applied Psychology

Winners and Losers in Transition: Preferences For Redistribution and Nostalgia For Communism In Eastern Europe Kyklos

'Freedom From' and 'Freedom To' across countries Social Indicators Research

Natural Sprawl Administration & Society (Disputatio Sine Fine section) (section of the journal reviewed by editor only)

2013 Cluttered Writing: Adjectives and Adverbs in Academia Scientometrics

City Life: Rankings (Livability) vs Perceptions (Satisfaction) Social Indicators Research

2012 Does Religious Diversity Make Us Unhappy? Mental Health, Religion & Culture

Income and Well-being across European Provinces Social Indicators Research

2011 Berry B J L, AOK, An Urban-Rural Happiness Gradient Urban Geography

Geography of European Life Satisfaction Social Indicators Research

Europeans Work To Live and Americans Live To Work (Who is Happy to Work More: Americans or Europeans?) Journal of Happiness Studies

2010 Religiosity and Life Satisfaction Across Nations Mental Health, Religion & Culture

2009 Berry B J L, AOK, Dissatisfaction with City Life: A New Look at Some Old Questions Cities

EXTERNAL GRANTS

190k PLN (∼$50k) PI, "The effect of social transfers and social capital on happiness of elderly." Vistula University, Warsaw Poland, Polish National Science Foundation (Narodowe Centrum Nauki NCN) 2016/21/B/HS4/03058 .. 2017-2019

$1.5k Consultant (summer salary), "Health information inequity in South Jersey-Vineland" South Jersey Institute for Population Health (SJIPH) Catalyst Grant[1] 2026

INTERNAL GRANTS (and AWARDS and FELLOWSHIPS)

$12k faculty advisor, Rutgers Camden chancellor's dissertation completion award for Marlo Rossi 2026

$30k faculty advisor, Rutgers Camden urban innovation fund grant to Ojobo Agbo Eje 2024-2026

$15k PI, Rutgers Camden chancellor's interdisciplinary research collaboration grant 2023-2024

$1k Rutgers-Camden Research Council Grant Award 2016-2017

$1k Rutgers-Camden Digital Teaching Fellow 2016-2017

$4k Rutgers-Camden Rand Institute Faculty Fellow 2013-2014

$1k Rutgers-Camden Civic Engagement Faculty Fellow 2013-2014

TEACHING (note curriculum development: [developed/designed] or [re-designed])

2025 recipient of department's Jay A Sigler award for "outstanding service and dedication to students" (awarded by students); the plaque says "this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student's academic development and personal growth."

GIS for data science `https://theaok.github.io/gisPy/` [developed/designed] 2023-present

Data Processing (data management for data science) `https://theaok.github.io/datManPy` [developed/designed] 2023-present

[1] `https://sjiph.org/projects/health-information-inequity-in-south-jersey-vineland-rutgers-university-camden`. I was informed by PI that grantor said that we do not need after all the GIS part that I was going to do. I did participate in the grant proposal and got awarded, but then grantor apparently has changed his mind.

Data Visualization `https://theaok.github.io/vis` [developed/designed] 2023-present

Community & WellBeing (Happiness and Place) [developed/designed] 2018-present

Data Management [developed/designed] 2016-present

GIS for Public Sector/Urban mapping [developed/designed] 2012-present

Quantitative Methods 2 [re-designed] 2013-2017, 2024

Research Methods [re-designed] 2012-2024

Coping with Extremes: Ecological resilience & human well-being [innovative class co-taught with biology dept] [co-developed/designed] 2019

Introduction to Regional and Economic Development [re-designed] 2012-2014

Quantitative Methods 1 [re-designed] 2012-2013

SERVICE

SERVICE TO THE FIELD/PROFESSION:

Served on editorial boards:

- Applied Research in Quality of Life: Editorial Review Board[2] ..... Jun 2026-present
- Social Indicators Research: Associate Editor / Co-Editor[3] ..... Jan 2024-present
- Political Behavior ..... Jan-Dec 2019

Reviewed papers (3-4/mo or 36-48/year as of Jul 2026; "top journals" underlined; starting in 2022: last 2 digits of year of review shown):

- <informal/for a colleague> [24]
- Acta Sociologica
- Applied Economics [23,23]
- Applied Research in Quality of Life [23,23,23,24,24,24,24,26,26,26,26,26,26,26]
- Basic and Applied Social Psychology [22]
- BMC Psychology [26,26]
- BMC Public Health [26]
- BMJ Open
- British Journal of Political Science [25]
- Cities [22,23,23,23,23,23,24,24,24,24,24,25,25,25,25,25,25,25,25,25]
- City, Culture and Society
- City, Territory and Architecture [24]
- Cogent Arts & Humanities [23]
- Cognition and Emotion
- Communications Psychology [23]
- Communications Health [26]

[2] Editorial Review Board is a part of Editorial Board and involves increased reviewing load for the journal (about 10 manuscripts per year) and being "a guardian of the academic quality of the journal and trusted advisor to the editorial team."

[3] This is not just sitting on the board of the journal and having an occasional board meeting, I am editing papers every week spending as of 2026 $1 + hrs/wk$ (earlier as i was less experienced it was $2 + hrs/wk$) on skimming through the submitted manuscripts, inviting reviewers, reading reviews, and making editorial decisions.

- Comparative Economic Studies [26,26]
- Discover Cities [26]
- Discover Public Health [25,26]
- Discover Psychology [26]
- Ecological Economics [24]
- Environment and Planning A
- Economics and Politics
- European Journal of Social Psychology
- European Journal of Political Economy [23,23,24]
- European Societies
- European Urban and Regional Studies [22,22]
- Frontiers in Psychology [23]
- Global Transitions [24]
- Humanities and Social Sciences Communications [23,23,23,24,24,25,25]
- Heliyon [23,24]
- International Journal of Comparative Sociology [23,24,24,25]
- International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health
- International Journal of Applied Positive Psychology [26]
- International Journal of Psychology
- International Journal of Social Economics [22]
- International Journal of Wellbeing [25]
- International Perspectives in Psychology: Research, Practice, Consultation
- International Sociology
- Journal of Comparative Economics
- Journal of Contemporary Religion
- Journal of Economic Growth
- Journal of Economic Psychology
- Journal of Economic and Social Geography
- Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Personality Processes and Individual Differences [16]
- Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Attitudes and Social Cognition [26]
- Journal of Religion and Health
- Journal of Regional Science [26,26]
- Journal of Happiness Studies [22,23,24,26,26,26,26,26]
- Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management
- Journal of Public and Nonprofit Affairs
- Journal of Public Policy [23,23]
- Journal of the American Planning Association
- Journal of Urbanism
- Land Use Policy [23,24,24]
- Local Development and Society [25]
- Mankind Quarterly [26]
- Mental Health, Religion and Culture
- Millah: Journal of Religious Studies [25]
- Nature Communications [24]

- Open Psychology Journal
- Quality of Life Research
- Papers in Regional Science [22,22]
- PLOS ONE [22]
- Political Behavior [22]
- Political Psychology [26]
- PNAS Nexus [24]
- Problems of Post-Communism [22]
- Psychology of Religion and Spirituality
- Public Administration Review [24,25]
- Regional Studies [22,22]
- Review of Political Economy
- Rural Sociology [22]
- Urban Geography
- Urban Informatics [26]
- Urban Studies [25]
- Urban Affairs Review
- Utilities Policy [25,25]
- Science of the Total Environment
- Scientific Reports [24]
- Scienze Regionali Italian Journal of Regional Science
- Scientometrics [22,22]
- Semestre Economico (Universidad de Medellín) [22]
- Social Forces
- Social Psychiatry and Psychiatric Epidemiology [26]
- Social Psychological and Personality Science
- Social Indicators Research [as reviewer] [22,22,23,23,23,23,24,24,24,24,25,25,25,25,25]
- Social Indicators Research [as co-editor][4] [25, 25, 25, 25, 25, 26, 26]
- Social Science And Medicine [24,24,25,25,25,25,25,26]
- Social Science Research [23]
- Social Sciences & Humanities Open [23]
- Sociological Spectrum
- Sociology of Religion
- SN Social Sciences [26]
- Sustainability
- Sustainable Cities and Society
- Sustainable Futures [25]
- The Lancet Planetary Health (IF >10)
- Third World Quarterly [22,23]
- Wellbeing, Space & Society [22,25]

[4] As a co-editor of Social Indicators Research, conducted through reviews (printed out, marked up, etc). Note: this is different from regular editing, where I just skim through the paper or read some parts only; and hence this extra work is listed here separately from editing as reviewing [starting oct2025 each such review marked with 2 last digits of year]

Reviewed books chapters:

- 3 chapters in "A Research Agenda for Happiness. Why we want to know, what we know, and what we want to know additionally." Editors: Jan Ott and Ruut Veenhoven. Edward Elgar Publishing [26,26,26]

Reviewed books for:

- Routledge [22]
- Cambridge U Pr [23]

Reviewed grant proposals:

- Polish National Science Foundation (NCN)
- Israel Science Foundation (ISF)

SERVICE TO STUDENTS:

Publications with students (all students unless indicated: "[not student]"):

10. Golden L [not student], Valente RR [not student], AOK, Mikhaeil E, Do Unpredictable and Unstable Work Hours Reduce Subjective Wellbeing? Social Indicators Research 2026
9. AOK, L Martinez [not student], E Mikhaeil; Happy Colombia, Unhappy Bogota (urban-rural happiness gradient in Colombia) Wellbeing, Space and Society 2026
8. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Well-Being and the authoritarian welfare state: sector of employment and human happiness in Arab countries; Public Organization Review 2025
7. MJ D'Italia, AOK; Constructing General Human Agency Indicators (GHAIs) and a General Personal Agency Scale (GPAS); Social Indicators Research 2025
6. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Public-private job satisfaction differential: The case of Egypt; Public Organization Review 2025
5. AOK, BK Everett, E Mikhaeil; Happiness is In The Air if It Grows (Growing Places are Happier than Shrinking ones); Urban Affairs Review 2024
4. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Subjective well-being and urbanization in Egypt; Cities 2024
3. S Deb, AOK; Exploring the association of urbanization and subjective well-being in India; Cities 2023
2. FA Abarghuie, R Javadi, E Mirabi, AOK; Experience of urban thermal pleasure: A qualitative study to the understanding of thermal-scape quality; Cities 2022
1. R Stansfield [not student], E Aaronson, AOK; Police use of firearms: Exploring citizen, officer, and incident characteristics in a statewide sample; Journal of criminal justice 2021

Supervised dissertations for [year of graduation, first job]:

9. Isabelle Surielow (Prevention Science) [starting official dissertation hours in Fall 2026; already working on proposal in Spring 2026]
8. Wei Chen [28??]
7. Erick W Udogu [27??]
6. Douglas N Zacher [27??]
5. Marlo Rossi [26??]
4. Michael D'Italia [24, RU-Camden] PDF
3. Shibin Yan [24, Walter Rand Institute for Public Affairs] PDF
2. Aditi Manke [21, Virginia Tech] PDF
1. Shourjya Deb [20, SIPRI] PDF

Supervised dissertations for less than the whole duration:

1. Helena Cabezas [Fall 25 only]

Served on dissertation committees:

9. Jason Schweitzer (Prevention Science) [27??]

8. Brian Everett [27??]
7. Monty Sanders [26]
6. Kate Cruz [22]
5. Charles Ian Hugh Forsyth (University of Otago NZ) [22]
4. Straso Jovanovski [19]
3. Spencer Clayton [18]
2. Rasheda Weaver [17]
1. Chris Wheeler [17]

Served on dissertation committees for less than the whole duration:
2. Yanan Li [stopped serving just before the proposal in 2023]
1. Daniel Assamah [served untill before the defense in 2026]

Supervised data science master thesis for [year of graduation]:
6. Nalluri Chandrahas [26]
5. Bhavyani Dodda [25]
4. Thanvitha Reddy Munagala [25]
3. Pavan Satya Venigalla [25]
2. Het Rakeshbhai Patel [25]
1. Raman Srinivas Naik [25]

Served on master thesis committees in social science [year of graduation]:
2. Ethan Aaronson (crim) [20]
1. Rachel Wagner (psy) [20]

Independent/Directed Study (2014-present) [starting in 2023 counts shown]:
- sp26 sabbatical
- fa25 x1
- sp25 x4
- fa24 x7
- sp24 x2
- fa23 x1

DEPARTMENTAL AND CAMPUS-WIDE SERVICE:

Researchers/Predocs/Postdocs/Lab Members/Visiting Scholars:
- hosting visiting scholar, professor Leonie C. Steckermeier ..... Fall 2026
- summer research: Funmi: housing insecurity and happiness; Tansha and Mahshid: machine learning and happiness 2026
- hired 2 researchers (data scientists) to work on happiness in Colombia project (and assist students with research in my happiness class) ..... Sep 2025-Jul 2026

Rutgers-Camden departmental committees:
- Urban Studies undergrad, member 26
- Awards/Events, chair 2013-16, 2021-22; 2023-25
- Awards/Events, member 2012-13, 2019-20, 2023
- Strategic Planning, member 2019-20
- PR/Website, chair 2014-16

- PR/Website, member 2012-13
- PhD, member 2014-21
- Methods Qualifying Exam, member 2012-21

Other Rutgers-Camden departmental service:
- investigated research misconduct (plagiarism case)
- held dissertation seminars for a group of doctoral candidates (in addition to one-on-one) ..... Fall 2025
- led Brown Bag Seminars 2018-19; 2023-24; 2026-present
- As co-editor of a journal organized "Publish or Perish" workshop ..... Oct 2024

Rutgers-Camden campus-wide committees:
- AI committee ..... Fall 2025, Spring 2026
- Advancement and Promotions (A&P), member/ad hoc chair 2020-25
- Advancement and Promotions (A&P), member 2018-19
- Faculty Senate 2018-26
- Faculty Life, chair 2019-22
- Faculty Life, member 2014-15

Other Rutgers-Camden campus-wide service:
- led creation of MS in data science and associated certificate program 2019-22
- led creation and maintenance of data science lab 2017-22
- served as director for data science certificate: `https://graduateschool.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs/#certificates` 2022-present
- organized Geographic Information System (GIS) workshop attended by faculty from across the campus `https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/` 2017

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Provided data management for:
- Ohio Business Round Table (contracted by Miami University, Ohio; Contract Amount: $7,000) 2022
- 2018 Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study, Michigan Chamber of Commerce (contracted by Northwood University, Michigan; Contract Amount: $5,000) 2018

Assisted following Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects as a faculty advisor:
- data science MS Ojobo Agbo Eje: "Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative" project: [click for news item] [hired/supervised 4 students, budget $30k] 2024-26
- public affairs PhD Zach Chengcheng Yue at Walter Rand Institute: Covid-19 in Atlantic County 2025
- public affairs PhD Marlo Rossi at Walter Rand Institute: Abortion in South Jersey; and other projects on abortion: [click for news item] ..... Fall 2025-Spring 2026
- MPA Olorunfunmi Adebajo's internship at the Camden County Community Development Office's Homelessness Assistance Unit: [click for news item], ... 2024

Other community service:
- made GIS maps dashboard (containing work by students in my GIS class): available on campus or via RU VPN only: `https://maps-dppa.camden.rutgers.edu/index.php?search=map&title=Special%3ASearch&profile=default&fulltext=1` 2019-23
- assisted Hunterdon Central Regional High School student: happiness class project ..... Fall 2025-Spring 2026
- organized Geographic Information System (GIS) workshop for The Walter Rand Institute for Public Affairs `https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/vShortGeoda.pdf` 2019
- assisted DPPA faculty member in GIS mapping project 2026

MOST FREQUENT RECENT CONFERENCES

LASA (Latin American Studies Association): 2024

AAG (American Association of Geographers): 2015, 2016, 2017, covid19/none,

ISQOLS (International Society for Quality of Life Studies): 2015, 2017, 2018, covid19/none, 2023, 2024 (webinar), 2026 (regional)

ERSA (European Regional Science Association): 2015, 2017, 2018, covid19/none, 2023

AFFILIATE SCHOLAR

- Australian Centre on Quality of Life 2016-present
- CURE: Center for Urban Research and Education, Rutgers-Camden 2012-18
- EHERO: Erasmus Happiness Economics Research Organization, Erasmus, the Netherlands 2013-16
- Vistula University, Warsaw, Poland 2015-18

ADDITIONAL EDUCATION / CERTIFICATES

- Project management course by Google on Coursera 2026